

Day 57 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in Indian Polity (1)

READING MATERIAL

Covers the landmark April 2025 Supreme Court ruling on Tamil Nadu's Governor withholding assent to state bills — directly extending the Governor's-powers content from the already-shipped State Executive topic with a real, current case — plus a 2026 bill affecting the Supreme Court's own composition.

Q: What is 'State of Tamil Nadu v. Governor of Tamil Nadu' (2025 INSC 481), and when was it decided?

A: A landmark Supreme Court judgment delivered on 8 April 2025, by a Division Bench of Justices J.B. Pardiwala and R. Mahadevan, ruling on the Tamil Nadu Governor's withholding of assent to multiple State Legislature bills (many concerning Vice-Chancellor appointment powers at state universities) between 2020 and 2023.

Q: What did the Supreme Court rule about the Governor's power to withhold assent to bills?

A: That the Governor's power to withhold assent is NOT absolute — a Governor CANNOT exercise an absolute veto or a 'pocket veto' (indefinitely sitting on a bill without deciding) over legislation duly passed by a State Legislature. The power must be exercised in a time-bound, reasoned manner, in conformity with constitutional obligations under Article 200.

Q: What specific timelines did the Supreme Court prescribe for a Governor acting on a state bill?

A: Generally: grant or withhold assent within ONE MONTH, or return the bill (with reasons) within THREE MONTHS.

Q: What did the Supreme Court rule about a Governor reserving a RE-PASSED bill for the President?

A: Once the Governor returns a bill for reconsideration and the Assembly RE-PASSES it (with or without amendments), the Governor can no longer choose to reserve it for the President at that stage — the Governor's only remaining option is to grant assent, since allowing re-reservation would defeat the Assembly's power of reconsideration under Article 200.

Q: What unusual remedy did the Supreme Court use regarding the specific bills pending in this case, and what does 'deemed assent' mean here?

A: The Court used its discretionary powers under Article 142 to declare that the pending Tamil Nadu bills were 'DEEMED TO BE ASSENTED' — effectively treating them as if the Governor had granted assent, given how the withholding was found to be illegal and erroneous.

Q: What does the Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Amendment Bill, 2026 propose?

A: It proposes increasing the Supreme Court's judge strength from the current 33 to 37 judges (excluding the Chief Justice of India), by amending the Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Act, 1956.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. 'State of Tamil Nadu v. Governor of Tamil Nadu' was decided by the Supreme Court on:

- A. 8 April 2025 ✓**
- B. 15 August 2024
- C. 26 January 2025
- D. 1 January 2026

Explanation: 8 April 2025. [medium, web-research]

2. According to this 2025 ruling, can a Governor exercise an absolute or 'pocket' veto over a State Legislature's bill?

- A. Yes, without limitation
- B. No — the power must be exercised in a time-bound, reasoned manner ✓**
- C. Only during a State Emergency
- D. Only for financial bills

Explanation: No — must be time-bound and reasoned. [medium, web-research]

3. Per the Supreme Court's prescribed timeline, within how long should a Governor generally grant or withhold assent to a bill?

- A. 1 week
- B. 1 month ✓**
- C. 6 months
- D. 1 year

Explanation: 1 month. [medium, web-research]

4. If a Governor returns a bill and the State Assembly RE-PASSES it, what can the Governor do next?

A. Reserve it for the President

B. Withhold assent again indefinitely

C. Only grant assent — re-reservation for the President is not allowed ✓

D. Send it back to the Assembly a second time

Explanation: Only grant assent. [hard, web-research]

5. Which Article of the Constitution primarily governs a Governor's power to assent to, withhold, or reserve bills?

A. Article 161

B. Article 200 ✓

C. Article 213

D. Article 356

Explanation: Article 200. [medium, web-research]

6. Under which constitutional provision did the Supreme Court declare the pending Tamil Nadu bills 'deemed assented'?

A. Article 32

B. Article 142 ✓

C. Article 226

D. Article 368

Explanation: Article 142. [hard, web-research]

7. The Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Amendment Bill, 2026 proposes increasing the Supreme Court's judge strength (excluding the CJI) from 33 to:

A. 35

B. 37 ✓

C. 40

D. 45

Explanation: 37. [medium, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Volume

READING MATERIAL

Volume is the last of 10 named Aptitude sub-skills. Real exam evidence shows two dominant shapes: 'ratio of dimensions → ratio of volumes' (scaling), and 'melt/recast one solid into another shape' (volume is conserved, surface area is not) — both are core techniques worth knowing cold.

Q: Method — ratio of volumes from a ratio of radii (same shape): If the radius of one sphere is half that of another, what is the ratio of their volumes?

A: Volume scales with the CUBE of linear dimensions ($V = \frac{4}{3}\pi r^3$), not directly with the radius. So if $r_1:r_2 = 1:2$, then $V_1:V_2 = 1^3:2^3 = 1:8$.

Q: Method — melting and recasting (volume is conserved, NOT surface area): A sphere of radius 9cm is melted and recast into a cone of the same radius (9cm). Find the cone's height.

A: Set sphere volume = cone volume: $(\frac{4}{3})\pi(9)^3 = (\frac{1}{3})\pi(9)^2h \rightarrow (\frac{4}{3})(729) = (\frac{1}{3})(81)h \rightarrow 972 = 27h \rightarrow h = 36$ cm. The general shortcut: for melting sphere→cone of the SAME radius, height = 4×radius always (since the $(\frac{4}{3})r^3$ vs $(\frac{1}{3})r^2h$ relationship reduces to $h=4r$ when radii match).

Q: Real exam (already seen in an earlier topic, re-noted here): A sphere of diameter 8cm is melted and drawn into a wire of diameter 3mm. Find the wire's length.

A: Volume conserved: $(\frac{4}{3})\pi(4)^3 = \pi(0.15)^2 \times h \rightarrow h \approx 3792.6$ cm ≈ 37.9 m. (Same melt/recast principle as r02, just sphere→cylinder/wire instead of sphere→cone.)

Q: Method — volume of a cylindrical tank from its capacity: A cylindrical tank has capacity 1,848 m³ and base diameter 14m. Find its depth.

A: $V = \pi r^2 h \rightarrow 1848 = (\frac{22}{7}) \times 7^2 \times h = 154h \rightarrow h = 12$ m.

Q: Method — dug-out soil redistributed into a different shape (volume conserved): A cylindrical well of depth 20m, diameter 14m is dug; the soil is spread evenly to form a cuboid platform of base 20m×14m. Find the platform's height.

A: Well volume = $(\frac{22}{7}) \times 7^2 \times 20 = 3,080$ m³. Platform volume = $20 \times 14 \times h = 280h$. Set equal: $280h = 3080 \rightarrow h = 11$ m.

Q: Formula check: volume of a cube with side 5cm, and the relationship between a cube's volume and surface area.

A: Volume = side³ = $5^3 = 125$ cm³. If a cube's volume is 1000 cm³, its side = $\sqrt[3]{1000} = 10$ cm, so its surface area = $6 \times \text{side}^2 = 6 \times 100 = 600$ cm² (cube surface area = $6 \times \text{side}^2$, from its 6 square faces).

Q: Method — ratio of volumes for cone, sphere, cylinder of equal radius AND equal height: What is that ratio?

A: Cone : Sphere : Cylinder = 1 : 4 : 3, when all three share the same radius r and the same height h (for the sphere, 'height' = its diameter = 2r in this comparison). This is a frequently tested ratio worth memorizing directly.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. If the radius of sphere A is 3 times the radius of sphere B, what is the ratio of their volumes (A:B)?

- A. 3:1
- B. 9:1
- C. 27:1 ✓**
- D. 6:1

Explanation: Volume ratio = (radius ratio)³ = $3^3:1^3 = 27:1$. [easy, authored]

2. A solid sphere of radius 6cm is melted and recast into a cone of the same radius. Find the cone's height.

- A. 18 cm
- B. 24 cm ✓**
- C. 12 cm
- D. 6 cm

Explanation: Using the shortcut $h = 4 \times \text{radius}$ for sphere→same-radius-cone: $h = 4 \times 6 = 24$ cm. [medium, authored]

3. A cylindrical tank has capacity 4,620 m³ and base diameter 14m. Find its depth.

- A. 20 m
- B. 25 m
- C. 30 m ✓**

D. 15 m

Explanation: $V = \pi r^2 h \rightarrow 4620 = (22/7) \times 49 \times h = 154h \rightarrow h = 30\text{m}$. [medium, authored]

4. Find the volume of a cube with side 8cm.

A. 512 cm³ ✓

B. 256 cm³

C. 64 cm³

D. 640 cm³

Explanation: $8^3 = 512\text{ cm}^3$. [easy, authored]

5. If a cube's volume is 2,197 cm³, find its surface area.

A. 507 cm²

B. 169 cm²

C. 1014 cm² ✓

D. 338 cm²

Explanation: Side = $\sqrt[3]{2197} = 13\text{cm}$. Surface area = $6 \times 13^2 = 6 \times 169 = 1,014\text{ cm}^2$. [medium, authored]

6. A cone, a sphere, and a cylinder share the same radius and same height. What is the ratio of their volumes (cone:sphere:cylinder)?

A. 1:3:4

B. 1:4:3 ✓

C. 3:4:1

D. 4:3:1

Explanation: Cone:Sphere:Cylinder = 1:4:3 for equal radius and height. [medium, web-research]

Part C – General English: Grammar: Parts of Speech, Subject-Verb Concord, and Tenses

READING MATERIAL

Covers identifying parts of speech, subject-verb agreement (concord) — including tricky nouns that look plural but take singular verbs — and correct tense usage, especially the past perfect continuous for actions with duration. First topic of the new Part C Units I-VI track, replacing Unit VII now that all 59 literary works are done.

Q: Real exam: In "He makes rather a fuss about ordinary things," what part of speech is 'rather'?

A: An ADVERB (modifying the degree of 'a fuss') — confirmed by a real exam question, distinguishing it from being mistaken for an adjective.

Q: Real exam: Which sentence is grammatically correct regarding subject-verb agreement — 'His wages is Rs. 1,000 a day', 'Measles are a disease', or 'Politics has divided the country'?

A: 'Politics has divided the country' is correct. Certain nouns ending in 's' (Politics, Measles, Mathematics, Physics, News) are treated as SINGULAR despite their plural-looking form, taking a singular verb ('has', not 'have'). By contrast, 'wages' is always plural (takes 'are', not 'is'), and 'Measles' (a disease name) takes a singular verb ('is', not 'are') — both of the other two options were marked incorrect for getting this backwards.

Q: Real exam: What is the grammatically correct form of the idiom about time, and what error does a common variant contain?

A: 'Time and tide WAIT for no man' is correct. A real exam flagged 'Time and tide WAITS for no man' as containing a subject-verb agreement ERROR — the compound subject 'Time and tide' takes a plural verb.

Q: Real exam: Fill in the blanks with the correct verb forms — 'She ____ tired because she ____ the house yesterday' (using 'is/was' and a form of 'clean').

A: 'She WAS tired because she HAD BEEN CLEANING the house yesterday' — simple PAST tense for the main state, and PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS for the earlier ongoing action that caused it, confirmed by a real exam question.

Q: Real exam: Which tense is used for an action that had been ongoing for a specific duration up to a point in the past — e.g., 'At that time, she ____ a book for three months'?

A: PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS: 'At that time, she HAD BEEN WRITING a book for three months' — confirmed correct by a real exam question, which flagged the simple past ('was writing') as the error to be corrected when duration up to a past point is specified.

Q: Real exam: Among 'He is junior than me', 'He is a MLA', 'She is the cleverest girl in the class', and 'This is a best poem of Tagore' — which is the ONLY fully correct sentence, and what's wrong with each of the others?

A: 'She is the cleverest girl in the class' is correct (superlative 'cleverest' correctly takes 'the'). Errors in the others: 'junior THAN me' should be 'junior TO me' (comparison with 'junior'/'senior' uses 'to', not 'than'); 'a MLA' should be 'AN MLA' (the article depends on the SOUND of the next word — 'MLA' is pronounced starting with a vowel sound 'em', so it needs 'an'); 'a best poem' should be 'THE best poem' (superlatives take 'the', not 'a/an').

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. In "He makes rather a fuss about ordinary things," the word 'rather' is a/an:

- A. Adjective
- B. Adverb ✓**
- C. Noun
- D. Conjunction

Explanation: Adverb. [medium, question-bank-2025]

2. Which of the following sentences is grammatically correct?

- A. The wages of sin is death
- B. His wages is Rs. 1,000 a day
- C. Measles are a disease
- D. Politics has divided the country ✓**

Explanation: 'Politics has divided the country' — Politics takes a singular verb. [hard, question-bank-2025]

3. Identify the sentence with an error in subject-verb agreement:

- A. The team has been working hard
- B. Time and tide waits for no man ✓**
- C. He doesn't have a pen

D. He doesn't come outside nowadays

Explanation: Should be 'Time and tide WAIT for no man'. [hard, question-bank-2025]

4. Fill in the blanks correctly: "She ____ tired because she ____ the house yesterday."

A. is, had been cleaning

B. was, have been cleaning

C. was, had been cleaning ✓

D. is, has been cleaning

Explanation: was, had been cleaning. [hard, question-bank-2025]

5. Find the error and pick the correct sentence: "At that time, she was writing a book for three months."

A. At that time, she have writing a book for three months

B. At that time, she had writing a book for three months

C. At that time, she had been writing a book for three months ✓

D. At that time, she has writing a book for three months

Explanation: had been writing — past perfect continuous. [hard, question-bank-2025]

6. Which of the following sentences is fully correct?

A. He is junior than me

B. He is a MLA

C. This is a best poem of Tagore

D. She is the cleverest girl in the class ✓

Explanation: 'She is the cleverest girl in the class.' [medium, question-bank-2025]

7. Which correction fixes "He is junior than me"?

A. He is junior to me ✓

B. He is more junior than me

C. He is junior from me

D. He is junior of me

Explanation: He is junior TO me. [medium, authored]

8. Why does 'MLA' take the article 'an' rather than 'a' (e.g., "He is an MLA")?

A. MLA is always plural

B. MLA starts with a consonant letter but a vowel SOUND ('em') ✓

C. It is a proper noun exception

D. There is no rule — both are acceptable

Explanation: Articles depend on sound, not the letter — 'MLA' is pronounced starting with a vowel sound. [medium, authored]